

As if this wasn't enough, there are also bad guys out there trying to break into our private channels of communication. So what do we do?

There are many points of vulnerabilities when you are communicating with someone, be it email, phone calls, or whatsapp. This guide will teach you how to plug all these holes and secure all your means of communication.

Internet

• Wi-Fi router settings

Your Wi-Fi is your gateway to the vast internet. It is also what makes you the most vulnerable. No matter what you do, a badly set-up router will remain a big potential source of leaks. Follow these steps to secure your router:

1. Change the default admin password and the SSID of the router. Go to 192.168.1.1 and login using the default username and password you'll find in the manual (or try combinations of 'admin' and 'administrator'). If you want to go a step ahead, turn off "Wireless Web Access" too. This will make sure that only people inside your house with physical access via a LAN cable can change these settings.
2. Change the 'Security mode' under 'Wireless Security' to WPA2 Personal and use a strong password that doesn't have any dictionary words, and has a good combination of alphabets, numbers and special character. WEP is old and relatively easy to crack.
3. Update your firmware regularly. New vulnerabilities keep popping up and new patches and updates are regularly released. You can do this either by going to your manufacturer's site and looking for updates for your specific model or alternatively, checking for updates under 'advanced' or administration settings tab in your router's control panel.
4. Go a step further and install custom open source Firmware like DD-WRT or Tomato. Most of the stock firmware on routers is clunky and includes many undocumented features and setting that can be exploited. There are many guides available online that teach you how to install custom firmware on your router. Link: <http://dgit.in/DIYHckRtr>

• TOR

It's ironic that a project that was started by the US navy has grown into something that is used by everyone from whistleblowers, to activists and privacy enthusiasts, to protect themselves and their identities from both the bad guys and the snooping government. TOR, short for The Onion Router,